

Noggin2

A personal second-brain system built on Obsidian + a local LLM assistant (Claude in cowork mode). No community plugins. No cloud ingest. Everything is plain markdown in one folder. Designed to survive ten years of daily use without ever requiring a migration.

The core idea: capture fast, process later. Daily notes are the raw stream. Topic folders are the refined knowledge base. An LLM bridges the two using tags as the interface. You never have to stop and think about where something goes. Just write. The system catches up.

Folder layout

Notez/	
_inbox.md	friction-free capture from anywhere
_meta/	protocol docs, assistant memory, decisions log
_templates/	daily note template
_compiled/	auto-generated intake logs and todo list
_digests/	weekly digests
_maps/	Maps of Content (hand-curated hubs)
_projects/	project tracker and Claude Code briefs
_rabbitholes/	deep-dive research notes
YYYY-MM-DD topic.md	daily notes at the vault root
Music Knowledge/	topic folder
Sculpture_Architecture/	topic folder
Literature/	topic folder
Hardware/	topic folder
Design/	topic folder
Ai/	topic folder
Video Games/	topic folder

Hide from graph view: _meta/, _compiled/, _digests/, _templates/, _rabbitholes/, _inbox.md

Daily notes

One per day. Today is always bare YYYY-MM-DD.md. After the day rolls over, Claude adds a 2-4 word topic suffix: 2026-04-11 ripleys seiko.md. The topic is the single most memorable or unusual thing in the note, not the most important. This gives graph view actual memory hooks instead of a wall of dates.

Template at _templates/daily_template.md gets auto-filled by Obsidian's core Daily Notes plugin.

Daily notes are append-only. Claude never rewrites the body. Its edits are limited to appending footnote markers ([^c-1]) and definitions in a ## footnotes section at the bottom.

Tags

Tags Claude acts on

Tag	What happens
#askclaude	Claude answers via footnote. Simple answers go in ## footnotes at bottom of note. Complex answers get their own topic-folder note, referenced from a short footnote
#link-me	Claude does a linking pass: finds related notes, adds wikilinks, makes them bidirectional
#todo	Compiled into _compiled/todos.md as a checkbox list. Check the box to mark done. Add #todo-done to the source line to archive it out of the list entirely
#inspo	Section captured into _compiled/inspiration.md. Drop alongside a domain tag (#Design, #Hardware, etc) for filtering. Captures from the tag line down to the next --- or next tag-prefixed line
#seed	Your own creative fragments (story ideas, premises, sketches). Compiled per-topic into Topic/seeds.md. Same section capture as #inspo but routes by co-occurring domain tag
#claudecode	Idea for something to build in Claude Code. Claude creates a project brief at _projects/<slug>/brief.md with architecture, implementation plan, and a ready-to-paste Claude Code session prompt
#title-me	Fetch page title for a raw URL and replace with a titled markdown link. Tag disappears on success. On failure, tag stays and a footnote explains why
#rabbithole	Deep-dive research. Claude creates a thorough standalone note in _rabbitholes/ with structured research, sources, and wikilinks back into the vault
#dailymusic	Line compiled into _compiled/music.md
#dailyfilm	Line compiled into _compiled/film.md
#dailyquote	Line compiled into _compiled/quotes.md
#dailyart	Line compiled into _compiled/art.md

Tags Claude never touches

Tag	What it is
#deepdive	Your marker next to a link that goes deep. Not a request to Claude
#followup	Revisit later. Same deal
#Brightidea	Your marker for ideas worth developing
#todo-done	Your signal that a todo is closed. Claude filters it out on next regen

Your domain tags (unchanged)

#Music #Quote #Movie #Literature #Art #Design #Audio-synth #Hardware #Brightidea #Biology #Nanotechnology #Ai #Reverseengineering #GPU #mechs #space #arg #vhs #Robotics #philosophy #Burndownthestack #HoL #science #cartography

Claude reads these for context and co-occurrence but never processes them independently. They are yours.

Footnotes

Footnotes are the annotation layer. They keep the main body pristine while carrying commentary, sources, corrections, and Claude's replies underneath. Obsidian renders them natively (Ctrl-click to jump to definition).

Every footnote marker uses a namespaced prefix:

Prefix	Purpose	Example
[^c-N]	Claude's reply to #askclaude	[^c-1]
[^src-slug]	Source citation	[^src-wikipedia]
[^YYYY-MM-DD-slug]	Future-you annotating past-you	[^2026-04-12-wrong]
[^dig-N]	Digression you pulled out of	[^dig-1]
[^def-word]	Glossary / etymology drop	[^def-qid]
[^note-slug]	General side note	[^note-fuzz-pedals]

Definitions live under a `## footnotes` section at the bottom of the note. Claude always creates this section when adding its first footnote to a file.

The rule: never edit a past line to match new information. If something is wrong, add a dated footnote. The archaeology matters.

Workflows

Ask Claude a question

```
#askclaude what is the name of that Raymond Scott sequencer with rotating contacts
```

Claude appends `[^c-1]` to the line and puts the answer in `## footnotes`:

```
#askclaude what is the name of that Raymond Scott sequencer[^c-1]
```

```
## footnotes
```

```
[^c-1]: the Circle Machine, built ~1959 as part of the Electronium project. -- 2026-04-12
```

If the answer is big enough for its own note, the footnote is a one-liner with a wikilink: `[^c-1]: full list in [[Experimental Sculpture]]`. -- 2026-04-12

Drop inspiration

```
#inspo #Design tunnel books / accordion style 3d https://rarebooks.uflib.ufl.edu/...  
https://x.com/historichub/status/...
```

The section from `#inspo` to the next `---` gets captured into `_compiled/inspiration.md`. Filter later with Obsidian search: `path:_compiled/inspiration tag:#Design`.

Drop a creative seed

```
#seed #Literature A snail baby lives its life, growing older and longer,  
climbing the ever lengthening staircase that is its shell.
```

Compiled into Literature/seeds.md. Seeds are things you generated. Inspo is things you grabbed. They compile separately because they want different treatment: inspo gets returned-to-and-consumed, seeds get returned-to-and-developed.

Capture a todo

```
#todo build a compiler that mimics the genome
```

Shows up in _compiled/todos.md as:

```
- [ ] build a compiler that mimics the genome ^todo-27840b
```

Check the box when done. Or add #todo-done to the line in the daily note to archive it completely.

Title a raw URL

```
#title-me https://www.luhringaugustine.com/exhibitions/emily-kraus
```

Becomes: [Emily Kraus - Luhring Augustine](https://www.luhringaugustine.com/exhibitions/emily-kraus). Works with surrounding text too. If the page can't be fetched, tag stays and you get a footnote explaining why.

Go down a rabbit hole

```
#rabbit hole #Hardware how CRT electron guns actually work
```

Claude creates _rabbit holes/crt-electron-guns.md with a thorough research piece: history, technical details, sources, wikilinks to related vault notes. The one place where verbose output is the point.

Kick off a Claude Code project

```
#claudecode build an MCP server that wraps the discogs API
```

Claude creates _projects/discogs-mcp/brief.md with: what/why, architecture, implementation steps, dependencies, open questions, and a ready-to-paste Claude Code session prompt. Edit the brief as the project evolves.

Check your project dashboard

Open _projects/_index.md. Five tiers: active (building now), queued (ready to start), sparks (raw ideas), shipped. Auto-compiled from #Brightidea, #claudecode, and #projects tags. Tier placement is manual but the assistant suggests promotions during weekly digest.

Promote daily-note content to a topic folder

Ask Claude explicitly: "promote the seiko stuff from today into Design/". Claude creates or appends to a note in the target folder, adds a Source: [[daily-note]] header in the target, and adds a small > promoted: [[Target]] footer in the daily note. The daily note body is never rewritten.

Promotion is never automatic. Always on your request.

Request a linking pass

#Link-me

Drop it in a note. Claude finds related notes via grep, adds wikilinks inline and/or a Related: footer, and makes them bidirectional (if A links to B, B gets a link back to A).

Quick capture from anywhere

Open `_inbox.md`. Type one line. Save. Claude empties it next session, routing by hints:

- no hint or `->` daily goes into today's daily note
- `-> Music Knowledge` goes into that topic folder
- `-> append [[Note Name]]` appends to an existing note
- `-> askclaude` treated as a question
- `-> defer` stays in inbox

Regenerate compiled files

Ask "rebuild the compiled files" or "update todos.md". Claude regenerates from scratch by grepping daily notes. Compiled files are caches. The daily notes are always the source of truth.

Weekly digest

Auto-generated Sunday morning at `_digests/YYYY-wxx.md`. Summary of the week's daily notes, intake counts by category, recurring themes, unresolved askclaude, promotion candidates, and orphan notes.

The inspo/seed split

Two tags for two kinds of "things worth coming back to":

`#inspo` is external. A link, an image, a book recommendation, a video, a design reference. Origin is outside you. Compiles into one global file: `_compiled/inspiration.md`.

`#seed` is internal. A story fragment, a premise, a character sketch, a worldbuilding kernel. Origin is you. Compiles per-topic: `Literature/seeds.md`, `Hardware/seeds.md`, etc.

Both use section capture (tag line to next `- - -`) and both use co-occurring domain tags for filtering. The split exists because scrolling past your own ideas thinking they are someone else's links is a failure mode.

The todo aggregator

`_compiled/todos.md` is a living checkbox list compiled from every `#todo` line in the vault. Each item has a stable Obsidian block reference (`^todo-xxxxxx`) derived from a hash of the text and source, so your check state survives when the list is regenerated.

Two ways to mark done:

1. Check the box in the collector. Item moves to ## completed on next regen.
 2. Add #todo-done to the line in the daily note. Item disappears from the collector entirely.
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Obsidian setup

All core plugins, zero community plugins.

Daily Notes plugin: template path `_templates/daily_template`, date format `YYYY-MM-DD`, new file location at vault root.

Templates plugin: for manual template insertion via hotkey.

Outline, Graph, Backlinks: core navigation.

Excluded from graph: `_meta/`, `_compiled/`, `_digests/`, `_templates/`, `_rabbitholes/`, `_inbox.md`

Obsidian Sync (optional, paid): phone to desktop replication. The system works without it but Sync is how phone captures reach the desktop vault.

Rules

1. Today's daily note is never renamed. Topic suffix gets added the next day or later.
 2. Daily notes are never rewritten. Claude's edits are surgical (footnotes only).
 3. Promotion to topic folders is always user-requested, never automatic.
 4. Compiled files are caches. Regenerate from scratch. Never hand-edit (except checkbox state in todos).
 5. `#daily*` tags are paired with base tags, not replacing them. Both stay.
 6. Scheduled runs are grep-first: zero work means one grep and one log line. No wasted tokens.
 7. The assistant never does rename-and-revert on a file in the same session (virtiofs cache desync risk on fuse mounts).
 8. Screenshots can be OCR'd and removed. Handwritten content stays unless explicitly told otherwise.
 9. Never edit a past line to correct it. Add a dated footnote instead.
 10. No community plugins, no cloud LLM ingest, no automation platforms. Obsidian core + Sync + local assistant. That is the trust boundary.
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How to replicate this

1. Install Obsidian, create a vault
2. Create the folders: `_meta/`, `_meta/askclaude/`, `_meta/askclaude/log/`, `_templates/`, `_compiled/`, `_digests/`, `_maps/`, plus topic folders
3. Copy the `_meta/` protocol docs as starting points. Adapt `voice.md` to your own style
4. Enable core plugins: Daily Notes, Templates, Outline, Graph, Backlinks
5. Set the graph exclusions
6. Set up a cowork session (or any local LLM agent) pointed at the vault folder with read/write access
7. Configure a daily 6AM scheduled task: grep for pending tags, process `_inbox.md`, process tags, log results

8. Configure a Sunday morning digest task
9. Start capturing. Drop tags wherever. Let the system catch up

Key files

File	What it is
<code>_meta/SYSTEM.md</code>	Full system doc, shareable
<code>_meta/README.md</code>	Session-start checklist, tag conventions
<code>_meta/decisions.md</code>	Why the rules are the way they are
<code>_meta/footnotes.md</code>	Footnote annotation protocol
<code>_meta/seed.md</code>	Seed tag protocol
<code>_meta/todo.md</code>	Todo aggregator protocol
<code>_meta/askclaude/README.md</code>	Askclaude tag protocol
<code>_meta/voice.md</code>	How you write, so Claude can match tone
<code>_meta/rename.md</code>	Daily note filename convention
<code>_meta/compile.md</code>	Intake compilation rules
<code>_meta/linking.md</code>	Wikilink methodology
<code>_meta/promote.md</code>	Topic-folder promotion workflow
<code>_meta/digest.md</code>	Weekly digest generation
<code>_meta/moc.md</code>	Maps of Content protocol
<code>_meta/inbox.md</code>	Inbox routing protocol
<code>_meta/claudecode.md</code>	Claude Code project brief protocol
<code>_meta/title-me.md</code>	URL title fetching protocol
<code>_meta/rabbithole.md</code>	Deep-dive research protocol
<code>_meta/projects.md</code>	Project index compile protocol
<code>_projects/_index.md</code>	Your project dashboard (compiled)
<code>_rabbitholes/</code>	Deep-dive research notes
<code>_meta/future.md</code>	Deferred ideas, not yet built

When in doubt

Just capture. Drop it in a daily note or `_inbox.md` with whatever tags feel right. File-friction is the enemy of a second brain. You and Sunday-you will sort it out later.